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MARKETS OUTLOOK

CAUTION AHEAD

A series of events in the first few weeks of the New Year could shape the trajectory of the equity markets, especially the Trump administration's policies

BY RAHUL OBEROI

► **EVERY JANUARY** equity investors tend to tread cautiously, not the least because of the historical trend of negative returns in the first month of the year. Over 20 years, the benchmark NSE Nifty 50 index has declined on 13 occasions during this month.

Perhaps they will be even more circumspect this year considering the series of major events that are set to shape the trajectory of the markets over the next few months. First, there's the swearing-in ceremony of Donald Trump as the US President on January 20, an event that is expected to mark the